

happens when you get to a place in life where you're not just one to two months out from total financial disaster. You can make decisions that are in your best interest."

Jonathan's story had elements similar to Brad's story of using F-you money to leave his career as an accountant. But Jonathan was far from FI, or even half FI when he chose to cut the safety line. When digging out of debt, he cut expenses and simultaneously discovered that happiness didn't require spending a lot of money. Having no debt and minimal recurring expenses gave him the opportunity to make his decision from a position of strength. Power shifted from his employer to his side of the ledger. *ChooseFI* became his life's project. The smart choices he made earlier in life enabled him to make the decision to pursue that project from a position of strength.

Having the financial freedom to live life on your own terms is the ultimate reason to *Choose FI*. Take a minute to reflect on the idea that you don't have to wait until you hit a magic number or a certain age to retire and experience that freedom. You begin to gain more freedom the day you *Choose FI*. That power continuously grows as you aggregate marginal gains while working toward the end goal of FI.